The agent loop

AI agents · Upper secondary · Lesson 3



In this lesson you will

- Write the agent loop in Python.
- Stop a stuck model with a step limit.
- Test a loop honestly with a scripted model.

Key ideas

- Ask the model; an answer? stop; a call? run it, add it, ask again.
- A step limit stops the loop, whatever the model writes.
- A scripted model tests your code, not the model.

Activity: Be the loop

1. Set up (3 min): Model, tool, loop: one card each.
2. Play (7 min): The model reads its script; the loop counts.
3. Stuck (5 min): A script that never answers: stop at four.
4. Code (5 min): Fix the loop in the code step.

Write two script cards before you start: one that answers after a call, and one that never answers. No devices are needed until the last part.

Let’s discuss

1. Why is while True risky in an agent?
2. What should the person be told when the loop stops?
3. What could a real model do that your script never did?

Exit ticket

- Write the four steps of the loop from memory, and where the step limit goes.